

them after the first login. As an admin, there is a list of functions you can perform. The most important among them is the defining of Process. After login, you will find a tab called processes on your home page. Go to that tab, and the fun begins. There are three options here: *New*, *Import*, and *Browse Library*. *New* is what you should probably use if you are new to this; however, before taking the plunge, I would suggest you check the library process available. This will give you a good idea of what ProcessMaker is all about.

Processes are actually flow charts of a real-world process, with each block being a task. So, processes are a sequence of tasks, with each task equivalent to a real work action. The tasks can be assigned to different users registered with ProcessMaker; you can even assign the tasks to groups of users. You can create and edit the groups under the users tab (*Users > Groups*). Then, while assigning tasks, you can assign them to users as well as groups. If the task is assigned to a group, you can even decide how the tasks will be assigned to users in that group—in a round-robin fashion, randomly, or many more alternatives.

Besides groups, there is one more method of segregating users, by assigning them to departments (*Users > Departments*). This can be useful for maintaining your office structure in ProcessMaker.

Now, let's go to another feature: roles. Yes, like in real life, you have different roles for different employees. You can assign them the same roles here. Each user in ProcessMaker should have one role assigned. There are three default roles already present, but you can create lots more in the roles tab (*Users > Roles*).

I hope you didn't notice... but we drifted from *Processes* to *Users*. Actually—this was important, as once you are done creating users, you need to divide them into groups and departments, and assign roles to them; only then can we proceed with creating processes. When you go to the new tab under Processes, you will find a blank sketch board waiting. Here you can draw your process (yes, like a flow chart).

Right-click on the blank area and add a new task, then select the green balloon in the upper left corner of the blank area, drag and drop it on the task you just created. This defines the starting task, and without this, your process won't work. Right-click on the task, go to *Users* and *Groups*, and assign the task to the person you want to do it. Then select *Properties* and rename the task. Your task is now ready.

To move from this first task to the next in the

process, you have a list of options available. The transition can be sequential, parallel, or based on some evaluation—e.g., if the amount requested is more than 5000, it will go to a senior manager, otherwise to a manager.

After adding tasks one by one, at the end, you have to again mark the end of a process just like for the start, but this time use the orange bubble. Thus, you can create the whole process using this wizard.

Now what? Once your process is defined, and each task is allotted to at least one user, you can see that the user assigned with the first task will get the option to initiate a new case of that process (here, case and process are related in exactly the same way as object and class in Java) under the cases tab. Once a case of the particular process is started, users assigned with the currently executing task will get that task in their inbox. When they complete the task, it goes to the inbox of the next assigned user. For admins, there is the dashboard tab, where you can see what processes are pending with which user, and for how long, apart from other reports.

## Missing something?

Seems easy, right? It is easy, but it takes some time though. But as we all know, good things test your patience. Till now, it was a cake-walk, but what if you have specific requirements like taking a user input in some task, inserting your own piece of PHP instead of ProcessMaker's forms, or executing some query to the database before actual insertion of data, or any other action. Is ProcessMaker capable of handling these actions? Yes, it is. It is highly customisable software. Just play on with it, and you will realise that. In the next article, we will discuss the concepts of dynaforms, triggers, and input/output documents, which will help you get the implementation just like you want it. 

## Links

- <http://library.processmaker.com/>
- <http://wiki.processmaker.com/>
- <http://forum.processmaker.com/>
- <http://www.processmaker.com/demos/>

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